

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience supporting complex disputes and case preparation at BCLP, Freedom Law Clinic and Citizens Advice. Experienced in reviewing and organising large volumes of evidence, maintaining confidential and structured case files, tracking procedural deadlines and managing document disclosure. Skilled in legal research, drafting procedural documents and communicating clearly with clients about sensitive matters. Particular interest in procedurally rigorous, public interest legal work.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Specialised in international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, legal research and evidence analysis
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction, 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**

University College London

- Modules included Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

International Foundation Programme of Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Reviewed and organised large volumes of evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial in a complex investment arbitration
- Became the sole junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline: coordinated outstanding documents, tracked actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; amended sections of the memorial; conducted legal research
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout the matter
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Reviewed documents and prepared electronic hearing bundles; assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Maintained matter records via iManage; assisted with court filings, deadline tracking and matter opening and closure

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from instruction to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines across several active files
- Takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues across welfare, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options; translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals
- Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria; identifies evidential gaps and researches complex points

Q-Legal · London**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations, including children's personal data and adtech, and identified practical compliance risks
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; document review and redaction; electronic bundling; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; case management and time-recording systems; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; concise report writing

Case and evidence management: Evidence review and organisation; hearing bundle preparation; procedural histories; structured case-file management; deadline tracking across multiple concurrent matters; confidential document handling